

STORYBOARD

Definition:

A sequence of drawings representing the shots planned for a film or video production.

Purpose in Filmmaking:

Storyboards communicate visual ideas, sequences, camera angles, and the mood of the scenes.

Relevance to Architecture:

Visual Communication: Like architectural drawings, storyboards communicate ideas visually before they are built or filmed.

Spatial Planning: Storyboarding involves organizing and designing spaces for characters, similar to how architects design spaces for people.

Perspective: Both disciplines require the use of perspective drawing to create a sense of depth and spatial understanding.

Key Elements of a Storyboard

Framing & Composition:

How each shot is composed, deciding what to include or leave out, and the camera's angle and distance.

Similar to selecting the viewpoint for an architectural drawing or render.

Example: Wide shots provide an overview, while close-ups capture details—just like choosing an elevation view to show a building's façade or a detailed section for materials.

Lighting and Mood:

Sets mood, highlights areas, and influences emotional response.

Lighting shapes how a space is perceived and used similar to Architecture

Example: Bright lighting can make a space feel open and inviting; dim lighting adds intimacy or drama.

Movement & Flow:

Movement in storyboarding shows how characters or objects move, guiding the viewer's attention across the frame.

In architecture, movement translates to how users navigate through a space.

Example: Storyboard sequences create flow, while architects design corridors and doorways to direct movement.

Storyboarding as a Design Tool

Narrative in Architecture

Architects often create a "story" or narrative to guide their design choices.

Example: Designing a residential space where the narrative might focus on a journey from public to private areas.

In storyboarding, narrative is visually represented in each scene, helping viewers understand the story's flow and context.

User Experience:

Storyboards map out how characters move through a scene similar to tracking user movement in architectural spaces.

Architects use similar techniques to design the flow of movement and the experience of spaces.

Example: Storyboarding a gallery layout to envision how visitors will engage with the art displays and navigate the space.

Architectural Applications:

Many architects incorporate story-board-like techniques to plan spatial sequences and user interactions.

Example: Architect Rem Koolhaas uses cinematic techniques to explore narrative-driven spaces, while Bjarke Ingels uses diagrams and sketches as storyboards to communicate spatial experiences.

Interior architects can use storyboards to visualize how people will interact with spaces in a sequence, making it easier to plan user-friendly layouts.

Storyboards as a Presentation Tool

Visualizing Ideas for Clients:

Storyboards effectively present design concepts to clients, similar to how directors communicate with production teams.

They visually convey spatial experiences and user interactions, bridging the gap between the designer's vision and the client's understanding.

Collaboration Across Disciplines:

Storyboards facilitate collaboration with other professionals, such as lighting designers, interior designers, and sound engineers.

They provide a visual sense of the intended experience, promoting an interdisciplinary approach. This collaboration is essential in complex projects where multiple elements must work together seamlessly.

Step Guide to Making a Story-board:

- Choose Your Story
- Identify Key Frames
- Sketch the Frames
- Add Descriptions
- Consider Composition

- Refine Your Storyboard
- Finalize Your Storyboard

Conclusion & Key Takeaways

- Storyboarding is a powerful visual tool for architects.
- Enhances communication of design concepts to clients.
- Aids in spatial design, lighting, and narrative flow.
- Encourages interdisciplinary collaboration.
- Integrating storyboarding into workflows improves design presentations.